

1755

## LISBON EARTHQUAKE AND TSUNAMI

On 1 November, a powerful earthquake shook Lisbon, destroying thousands of homes and large buildings, including churches, where worshippers had gathered to celebrate the Feast of All Saints. The resulting tsunami swept across the Atlantic, hitting Martinique 10 hours later. Around 60,000 died in the earthquake, or drowned or perished in the fires that ravaged Lisbon for six days.



△ Depiction of Lisbon earthquake and tsunami

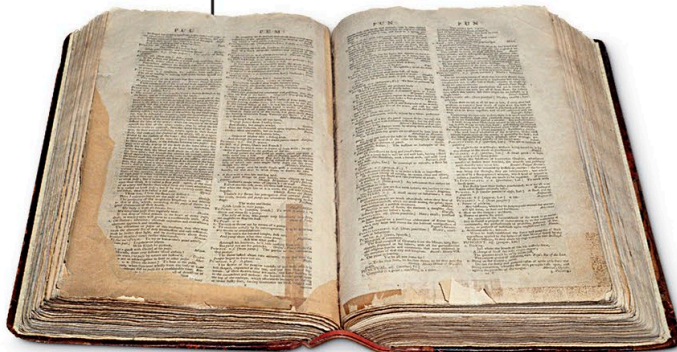
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**1756 Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart**, the influential composer, is born in Salzburg, Austria

**1756 Prussia defeats Austria** at Lobositz, Bohemia, in a prelude to the Seven Years' War

“I assure you that this extensive and opulent city is now nothing but a vast heap of ruins.”

REVEREND CHARLES DAVY, ON THE LISBON EARTHQUAKE AND TSUNAMI, 1755



△ Samuel Johnson's Dictionary

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## SAMUEL JOHNSON PUBLISHES HIS DICTIONARY OF THE ENGLISH LANGUAGE

It took Samuel Johnson and six assistants just nine years to put together his two-volume work; the equivalent French dictionary took 40 years. The *Dictionary* included over 40,000 definitions and around 114,000 literary quotations. Johnson's definitions were often subjective, reflecting his humour and prejudices. The work was only surpassed by the Oxford English Dictionary in 1884.